

Product Vision

Vision Statement

A context-aware AI campus assistant that helps students access campus information. It answers questions in plain language and gives fast, accurate responses, from "where is the tutoring center" to "when is the tuition deadline," by pulling from official campus data.

Problem

Campus information is scattered across disconnected systems like department websites, the registrar, financial aid, the LMS, email, and printed signs. Each has its own search, which is usually weak, and answers are often buried or out of date. Students waste time hunting for basic things such as where an office is, what a deadline is, or how to do a routine task. This is hardest for new, transfer, and international students who do not yet know the campus, and it floods advisors and front desk staff with the same repetitive questions.

Product Description

The assistant answers questions in natural language by looking up official campus information. Its core job is fast retrieval of two kinds of things: where (offices, services, rooms, buildings) and what or when (deadlines, requirements, common procedures). Every answer is grounded in real campus data so it stays accurate, and the bot returns a clear, specific response. For example, "The tutoring center is in Room 120, in the library building."

Target Users

- New and first-year students are still learning where everything is.
- Transfer and international students unfamiliar with campus layout and norms.
- Any student who wants a quick, correct answer instead of digging through a website.
- Secondary: advising and front desk staff, who field fewer repeat questions.

Key Features

- Wayfinding and campus directory: looks up offices, services, and rooms by name and returns the location as text (for example, "Room 120, Library Building").
- Natural language question answering: handles questions about deadlines, requirements, and common procedures.
- Deadline reminders: registration, tuition, add and drop, financial aid.
- FAQs: curated answers to the most common questions.
- Graceful fallback: when it is unsure, it says so and points the student to the right office or person.

Example Use Cases

- "Where is the tutoring center?" gives "Room 120, Library Building."
- "Where is the financial aid office?"
- "What floor is the CS department on?"
- "When is the last day to drop a class?"
- "How do I get my student ID?"

Scope

In scope for v1:

- Text answers for locations (room and building).
- Question answering from official campus info, deadline reminders, FAQs.

Out of scope for v1:

- Interactive campus map or turn-by-turn directions (stretch goal).
- Taking actions for the student, such as registering or paying bills.
- Official academic advising or replacing human staff.

Benefits

- Students find info, especially locations, faster.
- Fewer missed deadlines.
- Less repetitive load on advising and front desk staff.
- Equal, on-demand access to campus knowledge for everyone.

Success Criteria

- Speed: average time to find an answer drops to under 5 seconds.
- Accuracy: at least 90% of answers correct and grounded in a real source.
- Coverage: can answer the most common location and FAQ questions.
- Adoption: number of students using it.
- Satisfaction: positive feedback rate (thumbs up or short survey).

Assumptions, Constraints, and Risks

- Needs access to up-to-date campus location and deadline data. If data goes stale, answers go wrong.
- Must keep the information source current.
- Main risk: a wrong answer, like sending a student to the wrong room, erodes trust. This is reduced by grounding answers in official data and using the "not sure, go here instead" fallback.